

GAMEC Digital Platform Roadmap

A strategic plan for growing GAMEC's online presence from a community website into a full-service member platform.

Where We Are Today

GAMEC's website (igamec.org) serves as the public face of the organization — sharing our mission, programs, resources, and donation channels with the global Muslim Eritrean community. The site is fast, mobile-friendly, accessible, and optimized for search engines.

Current capabilities:

- 20-page public website covering all programs and services
 - Online Quran reader with surah navigation
 - Three donation channels (Square, PayPal, Zelle)
 - Donation receipt generator for tax documentation
 - Makkah and Madinah livestream access
 - Matrimonial services information
 - Mobile-responsive design for all devices
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Phase 1: Community Content Hub

Purpose: Keep members informed and engaged between events.

Capability	Member Benefit
Community announcements	Members stay informed about GAMEC news
Event calendar	Easy discovery of upcoming programs and gatherings
Khutba summaries	Access to Friday sermon highlights for those who missed them
Newsletter archive	Catch up on past communications
Email/RSS subscriptions	Get updates without visiting the site
Site-wide search	Find any resource, article, or program quickly

Organizational impact:

- Reduces reliance on WhatsApp/Facebook for announcements
- Creates a permanent, searchable archive of community communications
- Improves member engagement between in-person events

- Board members can publish content without technical help
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Phase 2: Member Accounts & Portal

Purpose: Give members a personalized experience and streamline administration.

Capability	Member Benefit	Admin Benefit
Member login	Personal dashboard	Know who your members are
Membership management	View status, renew online	Automated renewals, less paperwork
Event registration	RSVP to events online	Accurate headcounts, planning data
Donation history	View past contributions, download receipts	Donor relationship management
Member directory (opt-in)	Connect with other members	Community network visibility
Role-based access	Board sees admin tools, members see their portal	Controlled information access

Organizational impact:

- Eliminates manual membership tracking (spreadsheets, paper forms)
 - Provides accurate membership numbers for grant applications and reporting
 - Enables data-driven decisions about programs and events
 - Reduces administrative burden on board members and volunteers
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Phase 3: Program-Specific Tools

Purpose: Give each GAMEEC program digital tools tailored to their needs.

GAMEEC Youth

- Event sign-ups for sports, workshops, cultural celebrations
- Photo/video galleries from youth events
- Volunteer hour tracking for students

GAMEEC Sisters

- Workshop registration
- Resource library (educational materials)
- Private discussion space

GAMEC Seniors

- Service request forms
- Community connection matching
- Health resource directory

GAMEC Professionals

- Professional directory with industry filters
- Mentorship matching (experienced ↔ new graduates)
- Job/opportunity board

GAMEC Charity (Relief)

- Campaign pages with progress tracking
- Donor recognition (with permission)
- Impact reports with photos and stories

Matrimonial Services

- Private, secure profile submission
- Matching facilitation tools for coordinators
- Communication channel between interested parties

Organizational impact:

- Each program operates more efficiently with less manual coordination
- Demonstrates organizational capacity to funders and partners
- Creates measurable outcomes for grant reporting
- Attracts new members through useful, program-specific tools

Phase 4: Donations & Financial Tools

Purpose: Make giving easier and provide transparency.

Capability	Donor Benefit	Admin Benefit
Recurring donations	Set-and-forget monthly giving	Predictable revenue
Campaign pages	Give to specific causes (relief, youth, etc.)	Track campaign performance
Automated receipts	Instant tax receipts via email	Zero manual receipt generation
Donor dashboard	See giving history, impact	Donor retention insights
Zakat calculator	Calculate obligations easily	Increased Zakat contributions

Capability	Donor Benefit	Admin Benefit
Fundraising thermometers	See community progress toward goals	Motivate giving

Organizational impact:

- Increases recurring revenue (predictable budget planning)
- Reduces treasurer workload (automated receipts, reports)
- Enables targeted fundraising for specific programs
- Provides financial transparency that builds donor trust

Phase 5: Communications & Outreach

Purpose: Reach members where they are and grow the community.

Capability	Purpose
Email campaigns	Targeted announcements by program, location, or interest
SMS notifications	Time-sensitive reminders (events, deadlines)
Multi-language support	Arabic and Tigrinya content for broader reach
Social media integration	Auto-share announcements to Facebook, Instagram
New member onboarding	Automated welcome sequence for new sign-ups
Feedback collection	Surveys and polls for community input

Organizational impact:

- Reaches members who don't regularly visit the website
- Grows membership through better outreach
- Gathers community input for program planning
- Supports GAMEC's global reach across language barriers

Timeline & Priorities

Phase	Estimated Timeline	Prerequisites
Phase 1: Content Hub	2–3 months	Board provides content regularly
Phase 2: Member Portal	3–4 months	Decision on membership tiers/pricing

Phase	Estimated Timeline	Prerequisites
Phase 3: Program Tools	4–6 months (incremental)	Program leads define their needs
Phase 4: Financial Tools	2–3 months	Payment processor selection
Phase 5: Communications	2–3 months	Member database from Phase 2

Phases can overlap. Phase 2 and Phase 4 can run in parallel. Phase 3 is delivered incrementally — one program at a time.

What GAMEEC Leadership Needs to Provide

For this roadmap to succeed, the technology side needs decisions and content from leadership:

Decisions Needed

1. **Membership structure** — What are the tiers? Annual fee? Family vs. individual?
2. **Content ownership** — Who publishes announcements? Who approves content?
3. **Program priorities** — Which program gets digital tools first?
4. **Privacy policies** — What member data is collected? Who can see the directory?
5. **Financial goals** — Target for recurring donations? Campaign goals?
6. **Language priorities** — English first, then Arabic? Tigrinya?

Ongoing Content Needs

- Regular announcements (at least 2–4 per month)
- Event details (date, time, location, description, RSVP deadline)
- Program updates from each department lead
- Photos from events (with permission)
- Khutba summaries or recordings

Cost Considerations

Item	Estimated Cost	Notes
Website hosting (Netlify)	Free tier / \$19/mo	Current: free tier is sufficient
Authentication (Clerk)	Free up to 10,000 users	More than enough for GAMEEC
Email service	\$0–\$20/mo	Free tiers available (Resend, SendGrid)
Database hosting	\$5–\$20/mo	Only needed in Phase 4

Item	Estimated Cost	Notes
Domain renewal	~\$12/year	Already in place
Payment processing	Standard fees (2.9% + \$0.30)	Already using Square/PayPal

Total estimated monthly cost through Phase 3: \$0–\$40/month

The platform is designed to grow affordably. Most tools have generous free tiers that cover GAMEEC's scale.

Success Metrics

How we'll know the platform is working:

Metric	Target	Phase
Monthly website visitors	2x current traffic	Phase 1
Active member accounts	80% of paying members	Phase 2
Event RSVP rate	60% of invited members	Phase 2
Online donation percentage	50% of total donations	Phase 4
Recurring donors	30% of total donors	Phase 4
Content published per month	8+ announcements/articles	Phase 1
Member retention rate	85%+ annual renewal	Phase 2

Summary

This roadmap transforms igrace.org from an informational website into a platform that:

- **Keeps members connected** between events
- **Reduces administrative burden** on volunteers and board members
- **Increases donations** through easier giving and transparency
- **Supports every program** with tailored digital tools
- **Grows the community** through better outreach and engagement

Each phase builds on the previous one. Nothing is wasted. The foundation is already in place.